

# JINGYI TONG

Postdoctoral Research Associate

Charles H. Dyson School of Applied Economics and Management, Cornell University

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## EDUCATION

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| <b>Iowa State University</b>                                                                                                                                                 | 2020 - 2025 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Ph.D. in Agricultural Economics</li><li>• Fields of Interest: Agricultural and Environment Economics, Experiment Economics</li></ul> |             |
| <b>University of Wisconsin-Madison</b>                                                                                                                                       | 2018 - 2020 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• M.S. in Agricultural and Applied Economic</li></ul>                                                                                  |             |
| <b>University of Colorado-Denver</b>                                                                                                                                         | 2015 - 2018 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• B.A. in Economics, Minors in Math, International Studies</li></ul>                                                                   |             |
| <b>China Agricultural University</b>                                                                                                                                         | 2014 - 2018 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• B.A. in Economics</li></ul>                                                                                                          |             |

## WORKING EXPERIENCE

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| <b>Cornell University, Charles H. Dyson School of Applied Economics and Management</b>                                                                     | Current |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Postdoc Research Associate, working on experiment design on willingness to pay and conservation adoption</li></ul> |         |

## RESEARCH FOCUS

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Technology adoption, Cropland Use, Agricultural Pollution, Environmental Policy, Conservation Practice Adoption, Farmland Tenure and Ownership, Experiment Design, Women in Agriculture, Extension and Outreach

## WORKING PAPER

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- **Jingyi Tong**, Otavio Bartalotti, Wendong Zhang. "Institutional Land Ownership and Conservation Practice Adoption in the U.S. Midwest." (*Journal of Environmental Economics and Management* Revise & Resubmit)
- Xiaolan Wan, **Jingyi Tong**, Jacqueline Comito, Wendong Zhang. "Is a Farmer a Better Messenger than an Extension Professional for Conservation Practice Adoption?" (*Agricultural Economics* Revise & Resubmit)
- **Jingyi Tong**, David Hennessy, Shuchao Ye, Chaoqun Lu. "Grid-Level Dynamic Land Use Analysis of Farm Policy Changes in the U.S. Corn Belt with Application to Nitrous Oxide Emissions." (*American Journal of Agricultural Economics* under review)
- **Jingyi Tong**, William Chen, Wei Zhang, Wendong Zhang. "County-Level PFAS Contamination Site Density and Associations with Chronic Disease and Cancer in the United States." (*BMJ Public Health* under review)
- **Jingyi Tong** and David Hennessy. "Rootworm Corn Seed Disadoption: Land Use & Regional Welfare Consequences in the Inner Corn Belt."
- Jasmin Wehner, Tongzhe Li, **Jingyi Tong**, Wendong Zhang. "Plastic Waste or Fewer Pesticides? Experimental Evidence on Consumer Preference Tradeoffs in Sustainable Vegetable Production."
- **Jingyi Tong**, Jacqueline Comito, Wendong Zhang. "Who Influences Whom? Gendered Peer Effects in Edge of Field Practice Adoption among Farmers."
- Shuchao Ye, **Jingyi Tong**, Chaoqun Lu. "Declining Crop Diversity Increases N<sub>2</sub>O Emission in the United States"

## WORK IN PROGRESS

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- "Where Should Microgrids Go? Consumer Willingness to Pay across Community Locations." (**Jingyi Tong**, Yu Wang, Wendong Zhang)

- “Does Conservation Reserve Program Improve Crop Yield and Resilience?” (Shuaiqi Wu, **Jingyi Tong**, Shuchao Ye)
- “Do Futures Markets Help Participants Navigate Climate Shocks? Evidence from China’s Apple Spot–Futures Market.” (Ziran Li, **Jingyi Tong**, Wendong Zhang)
- “Consumers’ Willingness to Pay for Green Ethylene Plastic Bags: A Discrete Choice Design” (Yu Wang, **Jingyi Tong**, Hermine Zhou, Wendong Zhang)
- “What Drives Organic Cucurbit Growers to Adopt Mesotunnel Row Covers? An Application of the Technology Acceptance Model.” (**Jingyi Tong**, Wendong Zhang, Katie Dentzman)

## PEER REVIEWED PUBLICATION

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- **Jingyi Tong**, Michael Bootsma, Wei Zhang, Wendong Zhang. “Factors Influencing the Adoption of Flexible Lease Arrangements in Iowa.” Forthcoming at *Journal of the ASFMRA*.
- **Tong, J.**, J. Benning, C. DeLong, M. Schultz, W. Zhang. “What women landowners want to know about conservation.” *Renewable Agriculture and Food Systems*. 2024. 39(e35).
- Schultz, M., J. Benning, C. DeLong, C. Hyde, M. O’Rourke, L. Scarbrough, K. Tidgren, **J. Tong**, W. Zhang. 2022. “Survey Increases Understanding of Iowa Women Farmland Owners.” *Journal of The NACAA*. 15(2) ISSN 2158 9429.

## OTHER PUBLICATION

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- Wehner, J., **J. Tong**, W. Zhang, T. Li, K. Pulliam, D. Gonthier, A. Sciligo, E. Miller. 2025. “Kentucky Consumer Perceptions and Key Attributes in the Willingness-to-Pay Study for Cucumbers.” Cornell SC Johnson College of Business Research Paper. <http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5767702>
- **Tong, J.**, and W. Zhang. 2023. “Iowa Farmland Ownership and Tenure Survey 1982 – 2022: A 40 Year Perspective.” Iowa State University Extension and Outreach, FM 1893.
- Hart, C., **J. Tong**, W. Zhang. 2023. “The Continuing Evolution of Iowa Farmland Ownership and Tenure: Results from the 2022 Survey.” *Agricultural Policy Review*. Center for Agricultural and Rural Development, Iowa State University.
- **Tong, J.**, W. Zhang. 2022. “Educational Preferences on Farmland Leasing, Conservation Practices, and Transition Plans: Voices of Iowa Women Farmland Owners.” Center for Agricultural and Rural Development, Iowa State University.
- **Tong, J.**, Y. Zhou, and Z. Luan. 2016. “Establishing the Educational Evaluation System of Academic Advising for Sino-foreign College.” *24th International Conference on Computer in Education: Think Global Act Global –Workshop Proceedings*, Mumbai, November 28 - December 2.

## OTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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**Postdoc, Cornell University (Supervisor: Prof. Wendong Zhang)** 2025-Present

- Cost-benefit analysis of applied agrivoltaics in commercial farms in New York, also known as dual-use agriculture and solar photovoltaics (funded by New York State Energy Research and Development Authority).
- Field experiment: Consumer willingness to pay for crops grown under protective netting and row cover (USDA-funded project); and follow-up surveys to explore hypothetical bias, framing effects, and plastic aversion.
- Farmers’ willingness to pay for saturated buffer adoption: Reducing hypothetical bias using a real payment in experimental settings (The Nature Conservancy & Iowa Nutrient Research Center (INRC) funded project)
- Gender, delivery format, and wildlife conservation information: Experimental evidence on adoption of edge-of-field conservation practices (INRC-funded project)

**Research Assistant, Iowa State University (Supervisor: Prof. David Hennessy)** 2024

- Environmental impacts of commodity and fertilizer price changes on crop rotation and cropland expansion: Evidence from satellite data and an integrated economic–ecological model
- Impacts of rootworm Bt corn, alternative meat, and carbon policies on land use and welfare outcomes

- Research Assistant, Iowa State University (Supervisor: Prof. Wendong Zhang)** 2022-2023
- Land leasing, conservation, and succession among Iowa farmland owners (INRC-funded project)
  - Extension and outreach to women landowners on farmland leasing, conservation, and succession (USDA funded project)
- Research Assistant, UW–Madison (Supervisor: Prof. Xiaodong Du)** 2019,2021
- Effects of dairy insurance programs on dairy farm bankruptcy in Wisconsin
  - Predictive and causal analysis of Airbnb listing prices using machine learning
- Project Member, UW–Madison (Supervisor: Prof. Emilia Tjernström)** 2019
- Cost & benefit analysis of the Payments for Ecosystem Services (PES) program in Burkina Faso (World Bank Development Impact Evaluation Unit)
- Research Assistant, China Agricultural University (Supervisor: Prof. Zhiqiang Luan)** 2016
- Establishing an educational evaluation system of academic advising in Sino-foreign departments

## SKILLS

**Economic modeling:** applications of satellite remote sensing big data; instrumental variables and their use in nonlinear models; difference-in-differences models (and variants); lagged dependent variable models; contingent valuation methods; information treatments and field experiments.

**Software skills:** various AI tools, R, Stata, ArcGIS Pro, Python, LaTeX, Tableau, SPSS, Microsoft Office.

## CONFERENCE AND PRESENTATIONS

- **2026 Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meetings**  
Who Influences Whom? Gendered Peer Effects in Edge of Field Practice Adoption among Farmers
- **2026 Chinese Economists Society (CES) China Annual Conference**  
Less Plastic Waste or Fewer Pesticides? Experimental Evidence on Consumer Responses to Competing Sustainability Attributes
- **2026 Chinese Economists Society - North America Annual Conference**  
Grid-Level Dynamic Land Use Analysis of Farm Policy Changes in the U.S. Corn Belt with Application to Nitrous Oxide Emissions
- **2025 World Bank Land Conference**  
Institutional Land Ownership and Conservation Practice Adoption in the U.S. Midwest
- **2024 Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meetings**  
Dynamic Land Use Impact of Crop Insurance Subsidies in the U.S. Corn Belt: A Grid-Level Analysis  
Institutional Land Ownership and Conservation Practice Adoption in the U.S. Midwest
- **2024 Northeastern Agricultural and Resource Economics Association (NAREA) Annual Meeting & Workshop**  
Institutional Land Ownership and Conservation Practice Adoption in the U.S. Midwest
- **2024 Food & Human Values Society (AFHVS) and the Association for the Study of Food and Society (ASFS) Conference**  
What Drives Organic Cucurbit Growers to Adopt Mesotunnel Row Covers? An Application of the Technology Acceptance Model
- **2024 Extension Risk Management National Conference**  
Women Landowners' Voices from Iowa: Empowering Expertise in Farmland Leasing, Conservation, And Transition
- **2023 Iowa Nutrient Research Center**  
Landowners Matter Too: Accelerating Adoption of In-field and Edge-of-field Nutrient Reduction Practices through Better Engaged Landowners
- **2023 Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meetings**  
Land Management and Environmental Responses to Carbon Subsidies in the US Corn Belt

- **2022 Women in Ag Leadership Conference**  
Leave Your Legacy: Planning for Farmland Leasing, Conservation, and Succession
- **2022 Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meetings**  
Safety Net Programs and Family Farms Bankruptcy: Evidence from Wisconsin Dairy Farms

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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Economic Department, Iowa State University

- **Stand-alone Instructor:** Principles of Microeconomics
- Teaching Assistant: Rural Property Appraisal, Introduction to Data Analysis in Agri-Food Industry, Introduction to Agricultural Market, Farm Business Management, Microeconomic Theory

## REVIEWER FOR PEER WORK

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- Environmental Research Letters, co-reviewer with Prof. David Hennessy
- Journal of Soil and Water Conservation, reviewer
- Future Foods, reviewer

## AWARDS

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- “Women Landowners’ Voices from Iowa: Empowering Expertise in Farmland Leasing, Conservation, and Transition.” 2023 AAEA Graduate Student Extension Competition - second place.
- First-class academic scholarship with title *Deans List*; Distinguished student with Honor *Cum Laude* at the University of Colorado-Denver
- University Scholarship for Academic Performance at China Agricultural University

## REFEREE

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### **David A. Hennessy**

Cargill Professor in Economics Systems  
Department of Economics  
Iowa State University  
hennessy@iastate.edu

### **Wendong Zhang**

Associate Professor  
Dyson School of Applied Economics and Management  
Cornell University  
wendongz@cornell.edu

### **Xiaodong Du**

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Department of Agricultural & Applied Economics  
University of Wisconsin-Madison  
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